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Chapter 2

Housekeeping Overview



Introduction

To select a function in Housekeeping either enter the required option number in the command line or use the Roll keys to move the action bar so that the required function is highlighted, and then press **Enter**.

For each AS/400 computer installation there is a need to ensure the timely saving of the system's libraries and folders to off-line storage. The Housekeeping module provides the tools and utilities to perform and manage these activities.

The user specifies, for each library or folder, the desired save frequency (the number of days required between saves). The process of saving to off-line storage then involves two phases:

In the first phase the libraries which need to be saved are identified. This is done by comparing the date the library was last saved with today's date to calculate the number of elapsed days since the last save was made. The value of elapsed days is then compared with the save frequency as specified above. If a library qualifies for saving on the due date basis (as described) and changes have taken place since it was last saved, then it is saved in this processing run.

There is also a flag to force saving on the next run irrespective of due date and changes made. If you set this flag then the library is saved in this run without any eligibility checks being made.

This phase, the identification of libraries to be included in the 'save set', will normally be scheduled as an overnight task since it may typically take between one and three hours to execute depending on the number of objects held on the system.

The second phase - the actual saving to off-line storage - will differ system by system dependent upon system-level decisions having been made for each AS/400 installation.

The first method of saving is to associate a defined tape, cartridge, or diskette (identified by volume ID) for each library. This information is held on the system - for example, library ABC1234 is stored on tape OS2063. (The tape storage location is also optionally stored on the system along with the tape volume ID) The actual saving to off-line storage by tape, cartridge or diskette involves the system presenting to the user a display of libraries which are to be saved. This display is the 'save set' which was developed in the 'identification phase' as described above. The user must then select each library in turn from the displayed list. After selecting a library from the list, the system will instruct him/her to load the appropriate tape (diskette or cartridge). By merely responding positively to the tape load instruction (simply pressing **Enter**) the system will carry out the save and simultaneously update the control information held by the system. The process is then repeated until all libraries due to be saved on this run have been selected.

The second method involves the saving to disk (either a dedicated UASP or 'normal' ASP) of all the libraries in the save set. This process will typically be performed as an automated 'overnight' job and pre-supposes that there exists nn days (nn is provided at run-time by the user).

In addition to the above facilities which provide timely saving to off-line storage, and the identification of potentially obsolete libraries, the Housekeeping module also provides graphic representation (bar charts) of library size information. These bar charts display how the size of a library has changed over a period of six months or so, thus helping to plan future secondary storage (disk) requirements for the AS/400 installation.

Other key features provided by the Housekeeping module are:

- Creation of libraries
- Archiving libraries prior to deletion
- Media control
- Library compression
- File re-organisation

To access Housekeeping enter either 6 in the option field and press **Enter**, or use the Roll keys to move the 'action bar' so that it highlights the Housekeeping module and then press **Enter**.

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HK000                                Housekeeping                                System: STUDB30A

Main Menu
1. Control Details
2. Definitions
3. Save to Media
4. Operational Enquiries
5. Documentation
6. Execute Day-End Functions
7. Restore from Media
8. Exit

Selection or command
=> _____

F3=Exit      F4=Prompt    F6=Messages  F9=Retrieve
F10=Command Entry  F12=Previous F14=View Jobs F18=View Prints
  
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Alternatively you may wish users to directly access Housekeeping when they sign on to the IBM AS/400. To achieve this change your IBM AS/400 user profile so that STRIPGHKP is the 'Initial program to call'. Enter the command:



CHGUSRPRFUSRPRF(uuuuuuuuuu)INLPGM(IPGCFP4/STRIPGHKP)

